

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Financial risk and model-governance specialist targeting the Financial Risk Audit Manager, Vice President mandate at State Street, bringing ~7 years of independent review, effective challenge, and governance oversight across interest rate, liquidity, and market risk from the model-governance and practitioner side of institutional risk analytics. Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (\$50bn+ cumulative), sits on a model governance committee, and escalates outputs lacking economic defensibility. CFA charterholder; dual MSc (Financial Modelling, Engineering).

CORE SKILLS

Independent Review & Effective Challenge • Interest Rate Risk (EVE & NII Sensitivity) • Liquidity Risk & Cash-Flow Projection Analytics • Market Risk Analytics (VaR / CVaR - Portfolio-Level) • Model Risk Governance & Delegated Sign-Off • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Curve Construction & Spread Calibration Review • Issue Escalation & Exception Handling • Senior Stakeholder & Committee Engagement • Control & Governance Documentation Standards • Python & SQL Risk Analytics • Mentorship & Junior Team Development

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Independent Review, Challenge & Sign-Off

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Serve on the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Escalate outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and act as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, engaging directly with clients' Heads of Risk.
- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, confirming consistency of sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates.

Interest Rate & Liquidity Risk Measurement

- Oversee interest rate risk and duration analysis under parallel and non-parallel rate shocks, aligned with Basel-style IRRBB measurement standards.
- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios across ALM horizons.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed liquidity gap analytics (T+1 through multi-year) supporting funding optimization and refinancing risk assessment.
- Review aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream ALM and capital processes.

Governance, Documentation & Stakeholder Reporting

- Operate within a formal model-governance framework, building documentation and validation standards consistent with SR 11-7-style and OSFI E-23 regulatory expectations.
- Prepare analytical summaries for senior stakeholders on interest rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities, translating technical results into committee-ready narratives.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable Python pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and auditability controls.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms on the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM) and PFaroe PM platforms, validating model outputs post-deployment.
- Acted as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, translating risk and ALM configuration requirements into structured development requests.

Ernst & Young (EY)**Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation**

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurers, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and financial-reporting frameworks.
- Contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes for financial institutions, advising actuarial, finance, IT, and risk functions on standard adoption.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone delivery and implementation materials.

Ortec Finance Canada**Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk**

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and attribution to test robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Delivered ALM studies for pension funds and institutional investors, analyzing funding ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet risk exposures.
- Performed cash flow, liquidity, and hedging analysis across interest rate, inflation, and currency risk for international institutional clients.
- Presented study findings and stress-testing conclusions to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients on-site.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016